

Q. The industrial revolution, occurring first in England due to internal and external condition brought with it unprecedented economic growth. However this success was possible at the cost of the working classDiscuss.

Introduction: The term "revolution" implies a fundamental change during the second half of the 18th century and the first half of the 19th century. British industry underwent great changes (eg, change in industrial method from hard work to work done by machineries driven by power and in industrial organization from work at home to work in factories) ~ changes so remarkable in character and so extensive that the term 'industrial revolution' has been applied to them. The industrial revolution occurred first in England due to a number of internal and external conditions which resulted in unprecedented economic growth. But this success was possible at the cost of the working class. The present analysis intends to establish this proposition.

Brief overview of the internal and external conditions that led to I R

During 1760-1860 England, France, Germany, Holland and Spain were nations on Western Europe. But the I R occurred first in England. Because, it beyond dispute that, by the 18th century. England was exceptionally well prepared to produce and absorb the changes which the first break-through involved (Gill-1980).

Internal condition:

01. **Political stability:** During the 18th and 19th centuries England was under strong and effective political authority which was favorable to an I R and there was full security of life and wealth of people.
02. **Geographical advantage:** The geographical location of the UK was very liking for setting industries and it was a temperate zone which helped the people to work hard and harder.
03. **Effects of science and technology:** During the 18th century a dramatical change occurred in case of science and technology in England. As noted below

Year	Innovation	Application
1709	Coke smelting process	Iron and steel industries
1733	Flying shuttle	Textile
1761	Manchester waterway canal	Water transport
1764	Spinning jenny	Textile
1769	Steam engine	All industries
1776	Introduction of four course rotation of crops	Agriculture
1776	Steam blast for smelting iron with coke	Iron and steel industries
1779	The spinning mule	Textile
1785	Power loom	Textile

Source :Gill 1963

The age was running mad after these innovations which sharpened industrial production.

- 04.**Development of the Banking system:** During the 19th century from long distance trade England earned huge amount of profit. Banks well organized profits which led to new investment.
- 05.**Developed and liberal social system:** Which was free from (a) superstition and (b) Racial discrimination.
- 06.**Adequate supply of natural resources.**
- 07.**Increment of population and urban concentration.**
- 08.**Presence of entrepreneurship for industrial development:** note that, an entrepreneur is the man who sees the opportunity for introducing a new technique or a new commodity. But the need not be a capitalist.
- 09.**Agricultural development:** This was accomplished through the replacement of two field crop rotation by three field crop system and introduction of horses in place of oxen in agriculture and transportation. The production factor and the market contribution of agricultural sector sharpen industrial revolution.
- 10.**Improvement of transportation and communication.**
- 11.**Influence of great ideas which eradicate old and odd ideas.**
- 12.**Introduction of individualism in the economic related field.**

External condition:

01. **Colonialization:** Among the western European countries England was successful of ushering a period of colonializationAfrican, Asian and latin American countries. From this colonies England extracted capital and raw materials ,which sharpened the industrialization.
02. **Increase in long distance trade:** Which resulted a large blow of precious metal (silver, gold etc) to England. There was a larger international market England's industrial products which provided incentive to produce more.

The IR brought unprecedented economic growth; output of manufactured goods approximately doubled in the second half of the 18th century and grew even more rapidly in the early 19th century. This led England into a position of the greatest economic and political power in that time, (Hunt-1990). But the success was possible at the cost of the class explained below.

The social cost of IR

Historically it has seen that all type of revolution succeed at the cost of the people who had a bare subsistence existence in the society. So it was the IR in England. The working class lived near the subsistence level in 17th century and their standard of living deteriorated during the 2nd half of the 18th century ,(Beer-1920).

Throughout the period of the IR the standard living of poor falls precipitously in relative term. It has seen that, relatively the poor grew poorer, simply became the rich and middle class grew wealthier who invested capital in railway and spent on the bulging opulent household and on political municipal construction (Hobbsawn-1968). Undoubtly, the working class paid the social cost in term of the sacrificed consumption that was necessary for industrialization.

Again the new factory system completely destroyed the labor's traditional way of life throwing them into a nightmare world with which they were completely unprepared to cope. They lost their pride of workmanship. Their relationship with capitalist developed through in personal market or cost nexus. They lost their direct access to the means of production and were emerged as merely sellers of labor power and totally dependent on market conditions for their livelihood.(Engles-1844).

In preindustrial period the workers tasks were not so specialized. The worker went one task to another and gained freedom to take rest or to change the pace of the work routine. But the factory employment brought the tyranny of the clock and machine. The pace of work was no longer decided by the worker but by the machine (Hunt-1990). The late 18th century and early 19th century the worker has tried to win from the control of machine and capitalist under 'LUDDITE REVOLUTION' But this was ended in 1813 when large number of workers were deported for their activities(Ferry-1963).

The extensive division of labor in the factory made much of the work so simple that untrained women and children could do it like men. So most industrialist employed the children and women because they had to pay smaller amount of wage than men. The children were dealt as mere merchandise. Lots of 100, 80, and 50 were supplied and sent like cattle to factories, where they remained imprisoned for many years (mantoux-1927).

Women were mistreated almost as badly. Work in the factory has long, arduous, monotonous. Discipline was harsh; many times the price of factory employment was submission to the sexual advances of employers and foreman (Markean-1962). Women in the mines toiled from 14 to 16 hours a day stripped naked to the wist, working with men and doing the work of men. There were reports of the women who came out of the mines to bear children and were back in the mines within days after the birth. In short, industrialization was stern, harsh and cruel in the extreme for men as well as women and children,(Gray-1963).

The factory system resulted rapid urbanization but the working class didn't facilitated by improved water supply, sanitation, housing and other services. In contrast they were bruised by various types of diseases. The situation was described as civilization works its miracles and civilized men are turned back almost into a savage (Hobsbawn-1968).

Conclusion: Our present discussion has hopefully established the proposition that, though the I R occurred first in England due to internal and external condition with unprecedented economic growth. However this success was possible at the cost of the working class. The basic cause of this was the absolute and uncontrolled power and brutal candor of the capitalist. The workers were obligated to accept the wage that was offered by capitalist. As they had not anything except their labor power to sell which provided their means of survival.